University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Spring Semester 2026

8,232: High-Growth Entrepreneurship: An International Applied Perspective

ECTS credits: 4

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
decentral - Presentation, Analog, Group work group grade (50%)
Examination time: Term time
decentral - Written work, Digital, Individual work individual grade (50%)
Examination time: Term time

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
8,232,1.00 High-Growth Entrepreneurship: An International Applied Perspective -- English -- Souitaris Evangelos

Course information

Prerequisites

None.

Learning objectives

The educational objective of this course is to introduce students with entrepreneurial ambitions to the key issues involved in creating an international, high growth technology company.

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- **Recognise and evaluate high potential business opportunities** with the aim of creating real change in the world
- **Build an effective team** around a compelling opportunity
- **Assess and secure essential resources** including funding, talent, and technology
- **Write a clear and convincing business plan** suitable for investors and partners
- **Market new products in entrepreneurial environments** where speed and innovation matter
- **Grow a venture and successfully plan an exit** through acquisition, IPO, or other strategies

Get ready to think like a founder, take on real challenges, and explore what it means to build something bold and global.

Content

This is a **case based course** designed for students who learn best by exploring real entrepreneurial challenges. **Traditional lecture time and PowerPoint delivery will be kept to a minimum.** Instead, you will engage directly with the ideas, decisions, and dilemmas faced by founders, investors, and fast growing technology ventures.

You will still be introduced to **major theoretical contributions** through selected academic papers recommended by the instructor. These readings will provide the foundation needed for informed and insightful discussion in class.

Most sessions will focus on **a portfolio of case studies** that show how concepts work in practice. You will consider questions such as:
Should this startup pivot or scale? How should the founding team divide equity? When is the best time to raise capital?

Important: You must **read every case before class** in order to participate fully in the discussion. Required materials will be clearly labeled as **essential readings**. Additional materials will be identified as **optional** for anyone who wants to explore further.

Come prepared. Be curious. Think like an entrepreneur from the very first class.

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

This course follows seven parts of the entrepreneurial process:

1. **The entrepreneurial process**
2. **Evaluating opportunities**
3. **Building a team**
4. **Accessing financial resources**
5. **Growth**
6. **Maintaining innovation**
7. **Exit**

The course is built around real cases. These will be discussed using input provided by students through their active involvement. For each session, students are expected to:

1. **Study the essential readings before class** which will typically include one academic paper or one or more case studies.
2. **Participate actively in class discussion** and share insights based on the materials.

This teaching approach is based on two related ideas.
First, it is difficult to teach an applied subject without contextualizing concepts for specific organizations, industries, and countries.
Second, we strongly agree with the saying, *"tell me and I will forget, show me and I will remember, involve me and I will understand"* (Confucius).

In other words, the more you participate, the more you learn.

Literature

We will distribute a collection of **case studies, journal articles, and videos** before the beginning of the course. **Reading these materials before class is mandatory.** There is **no coursebook** for this class. All learning will come from the provided readings, cases, and multimedia content.

Additional information

For further information, please contact the teaching assistant for this class: djordje.djokovic@unisg.ch

Attendance is very important because the material in this course builds from one session to the next. **Please notify us by email before class** if you are unable to attend due to illness, a family emergency, or an unavoidable conflict.

A significant portion of **grading relevant information** will be presented during class sessions. For this reason, it is essential that you attend all meetings of the course.

Students who know that they will not be able to attend the entire course for substantial reasons should **contact us before the start of the course.**

University of St.Gallen

Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/2)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Presentation
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Oral examination
Examination mode	Analog
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Group work group grade
Weighting	50%
Duration	--

Languages

Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark

Pitch presentations on final course day.

Examination-aid rule

Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids

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2. Examination sub part (2/2)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written work
Responsible for organisation	decentral
Examination form	Written work
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Term time
Examination execution	Asynchronous
Examination location	On Campus
Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	50%
Duration	--

Languages

Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark

Evaluating and reflecting on the business idea.

Examination-aid rule
Free aids provision

Basically, students are free to choose aids. Any restrictions are defined by the faculty members in charge of the examination under supplementary aids.

Supplementary aids
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Content

1. Group Assignment: Pitch Presentation

Your group will create an **8 minute pitch** for an entrepreneurial product or service with high growth potential. Think big and be ambitious. Make sure to address the following questions:

What is the business model?
How will you build your team?
Where and how will you find funding?
What is your growth strategy?
When and how would you like to exit the business?

Use the management lessons and frameworks we have worked with throughout the course. If there are perceived injustices between team members, the assignment may include peer evaluations.

If in person presentations are not possible, your group will submit a **prerecorded video pitch** instead.

2. Individual Assignment: Opportunity Report

Each student must write an **individual report** of no more than 2500 words. This report should critically evaluate the group opportunity, assess its strengths and weaknesses, and offer a **plan B** in case the original plan does not work.

Literature
See syllabus.

Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW21) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 13 (Monday, 23rd March 2026) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 04 (Thursday, 22nd January 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 12 (Monday, 16 March 2026);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 14 (Monday, 30 March 2026);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 15 (Monday, 06 April 2026).